

Chapter 10: Exchange in the Americas, Africa & Europe

Unit 2 • Ch. 10 • c. 1200–1450
AP World History: Modern

CUE COLUMN (cover & recall)

NOTES COLUMN (main content)

Trans-Saharan Trade Network

Overland routes crossing the Sahara Desert connecting West Africa → North Africa → Mediterranean

- Enabling technology: **camel** (dromedary) — carries heavy loads, survives weeks without water
- Primary goods: **gold** (south → north) + **salt** (north → south) — complementary resources
- Gold from: Bambuk & Bure goldfields (West Africa); Salt from: Taghaza mines (Sahara)
- Islam spread SOUTHWARD along these routes via Muslim merchants — same mechanism as Indian Ocean

Mali Empire & Mansa Musa

Mali Empire (c. 1230–1430s): dominant West African state; controlled gold trade routes

- Founder: Sundiata Keita (c. 1235) — story preserved in *Epic of Sundiata* by griots
- **Mansa Musa (r. c. 1312–1337):** richest ruler in world at his peak
- 1324–25 Hajj to Mecca: ~60,000+ entourage; distributed so much gold Egyptian prices fell for 12 years
- Hajj placed Mali on Islamic + European world maps (Catalan Atlas 1375)

Timbuktu: Islamic scholarly center produced by trans-Saharan trade wealth

The Americas: Aztec (Mexico)

Tenochtitlán: one of the world's largest cities by 1400; capital of Aztec Empire

- **Pochteca:** professional long-distance merchants organized in hereditary guilds — traded luxury goods (cacao, jade, obsidian, quetzal feathers) beyond imperial borders — also served as spies and diplomatic agents for the Aztec state
- **Tlatelolco market:** impressed Spanish conquistadors as equal to Seville's markets
- Economy: hybrid — tribute from conquered peoples + active commercial markets

The Americas: Inca Empire

Inca (Tawantinsuyu): largest pre-Columbian state; ~2,500 miles along Andes

- **Mit'a:** labor taxation — subjects owed labor (not goods) to the state
- **Road system:** ~25,000 miles of roads; llama caravans; chasqui relay runners
- **Qollqa:** state storehouses for redistributing goods across empire
- NON-MARKET economy: state extracted and redistributed labor/goods without currency exchange

Inca vs. Aztec: Inca = redistributive state economy; Aztec = hybrid tribute + market

Americas' Isolation (CRITICAL)

The Americas had **NO biological contact with the Old World** before 1492

- No exposure to Old World diseases: smallpox, measles, influenza, typhus
- No Old World animals (except llama/alpaca): no horses, cattle, pigs
- Sophisticated internal trade networks — but biologically isolated from Eurasia/Africa
- ★ **AP EXAM: Americas' isolation = #1 reason Columbian Exchange was catastrophic after 1492**
- Populations with zero prior immunity → mortality rates 50–90% in some regions

Europe: Italian City-States & Trade Recovery

Venice & Genoa: western terminals of Silk Road luxury goods; distributed to European markets

- Genoese established Caffa (Crimea) — Black Death entered Europe from here via ship
- Commercial innovations: double-entry bookkeeping, marine insurance, bills of exchange, banking

Hanseatic League: northern European commercial confederation (Baltic/North Sea trade)

Italian city-state wealth funded the Italian Renaissance; financial innovations funded exploration

Black Death in Europe

- Arrived Sicily 1347 via Genoese ships from Caffa; spread rapidly 1347–1353
- Death toll: ~25 million Europeans (~1/3 of population)
 - **Social effects:** labor shortages → peasants gain bargaining power → serfdom erodes in West
 - **Political effects:** Church authority challenged (couldn't explain or stop plague)
 - Peasants' Revolt (England 1381), Jacquerie (France 1358) — plague-empowered laborers
 - Jewish scapegoating / pogroms — evidence of social trauma and fear responses

AP Exam Tips Ch. 10

- ★ **HIGH-YIELD: Mansa Musa's hajj is a prime AP stimulus source — know the details**
- TRAP: Don't say Americas had 'no' trade — they had sophisticated regional networks; just no Old World contact
 - TRAP: Don't confuse Inca redistributive economy (mit'a) with commercial market exchange
 - ↔ **COMPARE: Trans-Saharan vs. Indian Ocean — both spread Islam via same merchant mechanism**
 - ✓ KEY: Americas' isolation → Columbian Exchange catastrophe (Unit 3); Trans-Saharan decline → Portuguese maritime routes (Unit 3)

SUMMARY — Write a 3-5 sentence synthesis in your own words:

Chapter 10 covers three parallel regional networks operating independently during c. 1200–1450. In West Africa, the Trans-Saharan trade made the Mali Empire extraordinarily wealthy through the gold-salt exchange — Mansa Musa's 1324 hajj demonstrated this wealth to the entire Islamic world and placed Africa on world maps. Islam spread into West Africa via the same merchant diaspora mechanism as the Indian Ocean network. In Europe, Italian city-states (Venice, Genoa) served as the western terminals of Silk Road luxury goods, developing commercial innovations that would fund the Renaissance and later exploration — but the Black Death (1347–1353), transmitted via Silk Road routes, killed one-third of Europe and paradoxically eroded serfdom by creating labor shortages. In the Americas, sophisticated regional networks (Aztec pochteca, Inca road system, Mississippian river trade) flourished in complete biological isolation — a fact that made post-1492 disease exposure catastrophic.

My summary in my own words:
